



Taking Hold of Your Mind: “How” Skills

NONJUDGMENTALLY

- ☐ **See, but don’t evaluate as good or bad.** Just the facts.
- ☐ **Accept each moment like a blanket spread out on the lawn,** accepting both the rain and the sun and each leaf that falls upon it.
- ☐ **Acknowledge** the difference between the helpful and the harmful, the safe and the dangerous, **but don’t judge them.**
- ☐ **Acknowledge** your values, your wishes, your emotional reactions, **but don’t judge them.**
- ☐ When you find yourself judging, **don’t judge your judging.**

ONE-MINDFULLY

- ☐ **Rivet yourself to now.** Be completely present to this one moment.
- ☐ **Do one thing at a time.** Notice the desire to be half-present, to be somewhere else, to go somewhere else in your mind, to do something else, to multitask—and then come back to one thing at a time.
 - When you are eating, eat.
 - When you are walking, walk.
 - When you are worrying, worry.
 - When you are planning, plan.
 - When you are remembering, remember.
- ☐ **Let go of distractions.** If other actions, or other thoughts, or strong feelings distract you, go back to what you are doing—again, and again, and again.
- ☐ **Concentrate your mind.** If you find you are doing two things at once, stop—go back to one thing at a time (the opposite of multitasking!).

EFFECTIVELY

- ☐ **Be mindful of your goals in the situation,** and do what is necessary to achieve them.
- ☐ **Focus on what works.** (Don’t let emotion mind get in the way of being effective.)
- ☐ **Play by the rules.**
- ☐ **Act as skillfully as you can.** Do what is needed for the situation you are in—not the situation you wish you were in; not the one that is fair; not the one that is more comfortable.
- ☐ **Let go of willfulness and sitting on your hands.**

Ideas for Practicing Nonjudgmentalness

Leaving out comparisons, judgments, and assumptions:

1. ☐ Practice observing judgmental thoughts and statements, saying in your mind, **“A judgmental thought arose in my mind.”**
2. ☐ **Count judgmental thoughts and statements** (by moving objects or pieces of paper from one pocket to another, by clicking a sports counter, or by marking a piece of paper).
3. ☐ Replace judgmental thoughts and statements with nonjudgmental thoughts and statements.

Tips for replacing judgment by stating the facts:

1. **Describe the facts** of the event or situation—*only* what is observed with your senses.
 2. **Describe the consequences** of the event. Keep to the facts.
 3. **Describe your own feelings** in response to the facts (remember, emotions are not judgments).
4. ☐ **Observe your judgmental facial expressions, postures, and voice tones** (including voice tones in your head).
 5. ☐ **Change judgmental expressions, postures, and voice tones.**
 6. ☐ Tell someone what you did today nonjudgmentally, or about an event that occurred. Stay very concrete; only relate what you observed directly.
 7. ☐ **Write out a nonjudgmental description** of an event that prompted an emotion.
 8. ☐ Write out a nonjudgmental blow-by-blow account of a particularly important episode in your day. Describe both what happened in your environment and what your thoughts, feelings, and actions were. Leave out any analysis of why something happened, or why you thought, felt, or acted as you did. Stick to the facts that you observed.
 9. ☐ Imagine a person you are angry with. Bring to mind what the person has done that has caused so much anger. Try to become that person, seeing life from that person’s point of view. Imagine that person’s feelings, thoughts, fears, hopes, and wishes. Imagine that person’s history and what has happened in his or her history. Imagine understanding that person.
 10. ☐ When judgmental, **practice half-smiling and/or willing hands.** (See Distress Tolerance Handout 14: Half-Smiling and Willing Hands.)
 11. Other: _____